Honeycomb MCP: A Product Marketing Sample

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1. The two-minute version: web copy for an engineer new to Honeycomb

Ask about production where you write code.

Honeycomb's MCP server connects your AI coding assistant to your Honeycomb data, so you can investigate a slow endpoint or a bad deploy without leaving Claude, Cursor or VS Code.

- **Ask in plain language.** Your assistant finds the right data, runs the queries and brings back the answer.
- **Find what's different.** Across your real traffic, run BubbleUp and heatmaps from the chat to see what sets slow requests apart.
- **See the reasoning.** It shows which Honeycomb tools it used, and says when there isn't enough data to be sure.
- **Set up in minutes.** It's hosted, so there's nothing to run, and it works on the free plan.

Connect Honeycomb to your AI assistant →

2. What I found testing it

Free plan, sandbox sample data, about 5 minutes to connect to Claude. I asked Canvas, then Claude through the MCP server, why one 547 ms GET `/api/orders/{id}` request was slow.

- **Same answer, two ways.** Both traced it to a 251 ms database query (46%) and an inventory call that failed after 110 ms and retried in 88 ms.
- **MCP went further.** Claude found 63 ms of gaps between steps, and two calls running one after another that might run in parallel to save about 100 ms.
- **It knew what it couldn't prove.** It confirmed the cache miss only after checking `cache.hit`, warned that the auth service records its own `cache.hit`, and flagged a filter that didn't work as expected.
- **Where I got stuck.** The sandbox has one request to this route, so BubbleUp, the signature feature, has nothing to compare against.
- **Messaging takeaway.** Lead with "it shows its work," not "AI finds the answer." And give the sandbox enough traffic to show BubbleUp.

3. Message

Core message: Your AI assistant can already read your code. With Honeycomb's MCP server, it can also see how that code behaves in production.
Audience: Engineers who already use an AI coding assistant, and the platform and reliability teams who support them.

Pillar	What we say	Proof
In your workflow	Investigate from your editor or Claude, without switching tools.	Hosted server, connected in about 5 minutes.
Real analysis	The tools an engineer uses: BubbleUp, heatmaps, traces.	The server offers BubbleUp, queries and traces.
Honest answers	It shows its work and says what it can't prove.	Confirmed the cache miss only after checking the data.

4. Field note for sales engineers

Ask: "When production breaks, where do your engineers start, and how many tools do they open?" and "Which AI coding assistants does your team use today?"

They say	We answer
"What can the agent see?"	Walk through the connector's sign-in and permissions using Honeycomb's security docs. Never guess on security.
"Our engineers don't use AI tools yet."	Start with Canvas inside Honeycomb, with no setup. The MCP server is ready when they are.
"Our current tool already has AI."	Don't compare what we can't prove. Answer one of their real questions with BubbleUp on their own data.

5. Launch plan for a small release

When	What	Done when
2 weeks before	Confirm scope and plan eligibility; write the message and FAQ	An engineer has checked it for accuracy
1 week before	Update the setup guide; brief Sales Engineering with the field note	Someone new has set it up from the guide
Launch day	Blog post, changelog, customer email, in-app note	Published and linked to the setup guide
2 weeks after	Results and lessons, including what didn't work	Shared with Product, Marketing and Sales

Measures: teams connected in 30 days, weekly active MCP users, share of investigations started outside the Honeycomb UI, and what 5 customers say in follow-up calls.